MOCK EXAMINATION · EXPERT LEVEL · SHAMASE STUDIOS

DaVinci Resolve Mastery

Five hours. One hundred and fifty scenario-based questions. The exam tests decision-making under realistic constraints — not button locations or trivia.

Duration	Questions
5 hours	150
Pass mark	**Format**
75% (113/150)	Single best answer

Instructions to the candidate.

1. Each question has exactly one best answer. Other options may be partially correct or technically possible — only one represents the strongest professional choice given the scenario.

2. Read scenarios carefully. The constraints (deadline, hardware, footage, client need) usually determine which option wins.

3. Mark answers on the separate answer sheet. No negative marking — never leave a question blank.

4. Recommended pacing: 2 minutes per question. Take a short rest at Q75.

5. Reference materials, notes, and software are **not** permitted.

SECTION I · MODULE 01

Foundations & Philosophy

> *8 questions on the post-production workflow, the seven pages, Free vs Studio, and project library management.*

001

A client commissions a 12-minute corporate documentary, deliverable in 10 days. You are fluent in Premiere Pro but have never used Resolve. The client requires only an H.264 4K master and an Instagram-ready vertical cut.

What is the most professionally responsible decision?

A) Switch to Resolve to learn it on a real project — the free version handles everything required.

B) Deliver the project in Premiere Pro and begin learning Resolve on a lower-stakes future project.

C) Use Resolve for the edit and Premiere for the colour grade to play to each app's strengths.

D) Subcontract the entire job to a Resolve specialist while you observe.

002

You're spec'ing a workstation that will primarily handle 4K H.265 multicam interviews, light colour, no Fusion, and Fairlight mixes up to 24 tracks.

Which hardware spec is the weakest link to address first?

- **A)** CPU clock speed — H.265 decode is single-thread limited.
- **B)** GPU VRAM — Resolve needs at least 12 GB for 4K colour work.
- **C)** RAM — multitrack Fairlight projects load all audio into memory.
- **D)** Storage I/O — H.265 multicam needs fast random reads to scrub smoothly.

003

A colleague claims Resolve's free version cannot be used for commercial work because of licensing restrictions. How do you respond?

- A) They are correct — the free version is for personal projects only.
- B) They are incorrect — the free version has no commercial-use restriction; Studio is bought for features, not licensing.
- C) They are partially correct — commercial use is permitted up to a revenue cap, beyond which Studio is required.
- D) They are partially correct — commercial use is permitted, but client redelivery requires Studio.

004

A client sends you a `.drp` file and asks you to "open the project." Double-clicking launches Resolve but the project does not open. What is happening?

- A) The `.drp` is corrupted; ask the client to re-export.
- B) A `.drp` is a project export, not a project file — you must import it into a library via the Project Manager.
- C) The free version cannot open `.drp` files from Studio.
- D) The `.drp` requires a matching `.drx` to open.

005

You must move a 90-minute project from your Mac to a colleague's PC running Resolve free for a single grading session.

The cleanest export strategy is:

A) Copy your entire Resolve library folder and tell them to point Resolve at it.

B) Right-click the project → Export Project → send the `.drp` plus a hard drive with the linked media.

C) Render a high-quality H.265 file and have them reimport it.

D) Save to a cloud library so the colleague accesses it directly.

006

A Studio-only effect stops working in a project that was briefly opened on a colleague's free version. The colleague returned it to you and the effect is locked. What's true?

A) The effect was deleted automatically by the free version.

B) The effect is still applied — only its parameters are locked while in the free version. Your Studio version will resume control.

C) The effect must be re-applied; free version edits permanently strip Studio-only features.

D) The project file is permanently downgraded.

007

In a typical post workflow, which Resolve page is used *last*?

A) Color — colour is the final creative pass.

B) Fairlight — audio mixing happens after picture lock.

C) Deliver — exports the final file once all other work is complete.

D) Edit — final trims happen after grade and mix.

008

A junior editor asks whether to learn Cut or Edit first. Their goal is narrative film.

The best answer is:

A) Cut first — it's simpler and Edit extends its concepts.

B) Edit first — narrative demands its precision; Cut is for fast turnarounds.

C) Either is fine — they share the same timeline.

D) Skip Cut entirely — professional narrative editors never use it.

SECTION II · MODULE 02

The Media Page

> *8 questions on import, organisation, syncing, and metadata.*

009

You receive 6 hours of footage on a client drive, already organised into folders by camera and shoot day.

The fastest way to bring this in while preserving the folder hierarchy:

- A) Drag each folder one at a time into the Media Pool — Resolve creates bins automatically.
- B) Drag all folders together into the Media Pool's *bin list* on the left — Resolve creates a matching bin hierarchy.
- C) Use File → Import Media for each clip individually.
- D) Drag all folders into Media Storage, then rebuild the bins manually.

010

The practical distinction between Media Storage and the Media Pool is:

- A) Media Storage holds camera files; Media Pool holds transcoded copies.
- B) Media Storage is the file system browser; Media Pool is the project's database of clips Resolve tracks.
- C) Media Storage is for video; Media Pool is for audio.
- D) Media Storage shows local drives; Media Pool shows network drives.

011

You shot a wedding with a Zoom recorder capturing ceremony audio while two A7S III cameras recorded scratch audio. You want to replace camera audio with the Zoom track across all 18 ceremony clips.

Most efficient workflow:

A) On the Edit page, drag the Zoom audio onto a new track and manually align each clip's waveform.

B) On the Media page, select all camera clips plus the Zoom recording, right-click → Auto-Sync Audio → Synchronize using Waveform.

C) On Fairlight, drag the Zoom and use dynamic timecode lock.

D) On the Cut page, set both cameras to the Sync Bin and let Resolve auto-pick the best audio.

012

After Auto-Sync Audio across 30 clips, five report "not synced." Most likely cause and next step:

A) Those clips are corrupted — re-ingest from the source.

B) Those clips lack a matching audio signature in the reference — sync manually or check if they belong to a different take.

C) Sample rate mismatch — convert before syncing.

D) Resolve's sync only works on the first 25 clips; restart on the remaining five.

013

A documentary has 400 clips across 12 shoot days. You need to find every clip tagged "over the shoulder" so an editor can work on conversational scenes.

Best Resolve feature:

A) Smart Bin with a keyword filter — updates live as you tag more clips.

B) Bin colour coding — colour every OTS clip the same and visually scan.

C) Rename every OTS clip with "OTS_" prefix and sort alphabetically.

D) Resolve's IntelliSearch v21 — search OTS by AI vision analysis.

014

In the Media Pool's List view, which metadata field is the *least* useful for narrative work?

A) Scene

B) Take

C) Reel Number

D) Capture Application

015

A clip imported into Resolve shows 29.97 fps in a 23.976 timeline and plays back faster than intended. The right fix is:

A) Right-click → Clip Attributes → Video → change frame rate to 23.976. Resolve reinterprets without rendering.

B) Right-click → Force conform to timeline.

C) Delete and re-import — frame rate cannot be changed.

D) Switch the timeline frame rate to 29.97 — clips dictate the project rate.

016

A client provides an FCP XML and a folder of camera files. After import, several clips show offline. Most likely cause:

A) The XML references file paths that don't match Resolve's view — relink to the media folder.

B) FCP XML is incompatible with Resolve — request AAF.

C) The codec is not supported in the free version — needs Studio.

D) The XML was exported from a project with collaboration enabled.

The Edit Page

> *12 questions on storytelling mechanics, edit modes, keyboard workflow, and clip manipulation.*

017

You're assembling a scene from 30 takes across 4 angles. The director joins you in 90 minutes to review.

Highest-leverage thing to complete first:

- A) Carefully grade the wide master so the director sees the final look.
- B) Lay down a rough cut from master takes only — a watchable beginning-to-end version.
- C) Sync all audio and run the full project through noise reduction.
- D) Build complex transitions between every cut to demonstrate creative options.

018

Which edit button pushes later clips down the timeline to make space for the inserted clip?

- A) Overwrite
- B) Insert
- C) Replace
- D) Place on Top

019

A 4-minute interview clip has a 12-second dead pause in the middle ruining pacing.

Fastest method to remove those 12 seconds while keeping the rest intact:

- A) Trim from the left edge of the second half, then drag everything right back into place.
- B) Position playhead at the pause start, split (S). Move to pause end, split. Delete the middle.
- C) Use the Cut page's smart trim function to auto-detect silences.
- D) Lasso the pause region with the Blade tool and use a gap-removal command.

020

In Trim Tool (T), click-dragging the *lower* portion of a clip in its middle does what?

- A) Slips the clip — same in/out, different portion of source.
- B) Slides the clip — moves in time, trimming neighbours.
- C) Rolls the clip — moves its boundary with the next clip.
- D) Rate-stretches the clip.

021

A wide shot ends with the actor turning right; a close-up take also begins with them turning right. Cutting at the motion feels natural because:

A) The viewer's eye is occupied by motion, masking the discontinuity between angles.

B) Resolve's interpolation smooths the gap automatically.

C) Matching motion vectors trigger a temporal coherence effect.

D) Wide and close-up share the same colour space.

022

Which keyboard setup most accelerates dialogue and podcast editing once learned?

A) Defaults: `Ctrl`+`\` split, `Ctrl`+`Shift`+`[`/`]` for trim.

B) Custom: `Q` = trim start, `W` = trim end, `S` = split. Three fingers, one hand.

C) The Premiere preset for muscle-memory transfer.

D) The Final Cut Pro preset.

023

You keyframe a title sliding in from offscreen-right to centre. The animation works but jerks to a stop.

Cause:

A) Keyframes are linear by default — ease the outgoing keyframe by flattening its tangent in the Keyframes panel.

B) The title is too short — animations under 24 frames always jerk.

C) Resolve doesn't support keyframed titles on the Edit page — use Fusion.

D) The Inspector transform applies only once at clip start.

024

You keyframed a clip's position to move across screen. You duplicate the clip. The duplicate must animate identically. Most reliable approach:

A) The duplicate inherits the animation — just duplicate normally.

B) Use Edit → Copy → Paste Attributes onto the duplicate.

C) Recreate keyframes manually on the duplicate.

D) Create a Compound Clip from the original first — duplicating compounds preserves animation.

025

Enabling Snapping (the magnet icon) in the Edit page affects what?

A) Clips snap to nearby edit points, markers, and the playhead while dragging.

B) The viewer snaps to common aspect ratios.

C) Audio waveforms snap to even peaks for sync.

D) Clips snap to frame boundaries to prevent sub-frame edits.

026

A clip has good dialogue then 4 seconds of crew noise. You want to keep the dialogue and replace the noisy audio (only) with clean wild track audio. Video must stay intact.

A) Split the clip at the noise boundary, delete the noisy half, ripple-trim earlier content right.

B) Unlink V/A (chain icon), then on audio only: split, delete the noisy section, replace with the wild track.

C) Apply Audio FX → Noise Reduction on the noisy section.

D) Cut the whole video clip and re-edit from the source viewer's audio-only mode.

027

Simplest way to fade in a generator title:

A) Right-click the clip → Add Transition → Cross Dissolve.

B) Drag the small white triangle handle at the clip's top-left corner inward.

C) Apply a Fade-In effect from the Effects panel.

D) Keyframe opacity from 0 to 100% in the Inspector.

028

A 1-hour interview timeline. You need to render only minutes 12 to 18 for client preview without destroying timeline integrity.

A) Duplicate the timeline, delete everything outside that range, render the duplicate.

B) Set in/out (`I`/`O`) around the range, switch to Deliver, set render range to "In to Out."

C) Use the Cut page to chop out a sub-timeline, deliver from it.

D) Export the whole timeline as H.264 then trim the resulting file externally.

SECTION IV · MODULE 04

The Cut Page

> *6 questions on Cut-page workflow and multicam.*

029

The defining structural feature of the Cut page that Edit lacks:

A) Two separate timelines — full-project zoom-out plus detail zoom-in — simultaneously visible.

B) A built-in colour grading tool unavailable in Edit.

C) Faster rendering through GPU acceleration.

D) Native vertical aspect-ratio support.

030

A 4-camera podcast records 90 minutes; cut delivery is due tomorrow.

Strongest reason to pick Cut over Edit:

A) Sync Bin — auto-sync cameras and switch between angles live at the playhead.

B) Source Tape — scrub all clips end-to-end as one source.

C) The Smart Insert button.

D) Built-in autocut from voice-activity detection.

031

On the Cut page, clicking Insert with the playhead roughly between two clips does:

A) Splits the nearer clip at the playhead and inserts there.

B) Snaps to the nearest edit point (the boundary) and inserts there.

C) Inserts at the start of the timeline regardless.

D) Inserts on a new track above.

032

After Sync by Audio on a 4-camera shoot, one camera is offset by 2 seconds in the result.

Cause and remedy:

A) That camera's audio was too low to match — sync that camera manually using a sharp transient.

B) Save Sync corrupts the project — restart Resolve.

C) Resolve cannot sync 4 cameras simultaneously — sync in pairs.

D) Cut's sync is approximate by design; a 2-second drift is normal.

033

With Sync Bin active and the wide camera dropped as a spine, what does the Sync Bin display?

A) All clips for the entire shoot, sorted alphabetically.

B) Only the cameras whose audio matches the current playhead.

C) All cameras' angles aligned to the playhead position live — switch by drag-dropping with Place on Top.

D) The single best angle for each moment, chosen by Resolve's AI.

034

A narrative drama with layered audio, custom motion graphics, and dual-monitor reference grading is best suited to:

A) Cut — its dual timeline suits narrative density.

B) Edit — precision tools and full track control suit complex narrative.

C) Fusion — narrative work happens in the compositing page.

D) Color — grade first, then assemble.

CHECKPOINT · 34 QUESTIONS COMPLETE · ~Q75 MID-BREAK UPCOMING

Pace check: at 2 minutes per question you should be around 68 minutes in.

SECTION V · MODULE 05

The Fusion Page

12 questions on node-based compositing, masks, merging, tracking, and Fusion concepts.

035

A clip opens in Fusion. The two default nodes present are:

A) Camera and Renderer — reads the source and outputs to the timeline.

B) MediaIn and MediaOut — imports the clip and returns the result to the timeline.

C) Source and Sink — loads and writes to disk.

D) Import and Export — reads and renders.

036

A Merge node has three inputs (yellow, green, blue). Each accepts:

A) Yellow = background, green = foreground, blue = effect mask.

B) Yellow = source A, green = source B, blue = source C — combined equally.

C) Yellow = colour, green = alpha, blue = depth.

D) Yellow = video, green = audio, blue = metadata.

037

A polygon mask drawn at frame 1 was adjusted at frame 30. On playback it morphs between the two shapes unintentionally. Cause:

A) Bezier handles are unstable — reset them.

B) Polygons automatically keyframe shape changes — right-click in Inspector → Remove Polygon1 → Polyline.

C) The MediaIn is keyframed — disable its keyframes.

D) The Merge node is rendering inconsistently.

038

You want atmospheric smoke drifting only along a diagonal upper-frame streak.

Cleanest node graph:

A) MediaIn → ColorCorrector (dark cloud colour) → MediaOut.

B) FastNoise (dark clouds) → masked by a Polygon (streak) → Merged over MediaIn → MediaOut.

C) MediaIn → heavy Blur → MediaOut, then desaturate.

D) Background generator (grey) → Merge over MediaIn with composite Multiply.

039

You want to view one node in the left viewer while the final composite stays in the right viewer. Fastest method:

A) Connect two MediaOut nodes — one to each viewer.

B) Select the node you want and press `1` (left viewer) or `2` (right viewer).

C) Right-click each viewer and choose "follow node."

D) Drag the node onto the viewer header.

040

You're compositing an alien into a cockpit shot. The cockpit foreground plate and alien background plate are different resolutions.

The cleanest way to scale the alien to fit the cockpit window:

A) Run the alien MediaIn through a Transform node and use its size/position controls.

B) Open the source clip in Edit and pre-scale before sending to Fusion.

C) Use the Merge node's "size" parameter on the green input.

D) Convert both plates to the same resolution via the Project Settings.

041

A FastNoise node generates clouds you want to use as smoke. You want the clouds to drift gently across the frame over time.

The right control:

A) Keyframe the FastNoise *Center* control to translate horizontally over the clip's duration.

B) Animate the FastNoise *Seethe* rate from 0 to 1.

C) Wrap FastNoise in a Transform node and keyframe the Transform's position.

D) Apply a Glow node to the FastNoise output.

042

You want to track a moving person's eye and stick a graphic to it. The cleanest Fusion approach:

- **A)** Tracker node with target on the eye, set Operation to Match Move, feed the graphic into the green input.
- **B)** Use a Polygon mask drawn on the eye and keyframed.
- **C)** Apply Resolve's Color-page Tracker to the timeline clip.
- **D)** Use Magic Mask on the eye.

043

A node graph has MediaIn → ColorCorrector → Blur → MediaOut. You want the Blur to apply *before* the ColorCorrector. Best approach:

- **A)** Re-wire: MediaIn → Blur → ColorCorrector → MediaOut.
- **B)** Drag the ColorCorrector to the right of Blur visually — Fusion reorders by position.
- **C)** Delete both, re-add in the desired order.
- **D)** Reverse the connection direction on each cable.

044

A Polygon mask connected to the blue input of a Brightness/Contrast node — what does that node now do?

A) Inverts the polygon area's brightness only.

B) Applies its brightness/contrast adjustment only inside the polygon's white area.

C) Erases the polygon shape from the image.

D) Multiplies the polygon by the brightness output.

045

Magic Mask (Studio) is most useful for which of the following?

A) Generating cloud textures.

B) AI-driven rotoscoping — moving masks that follow a subject across a shot.

C) Colour-correcting individual frames.

D) Compositing two plates using a Merge node.

046

Best approach to bring a second timeline clip into the current Fusion composition (so both clips can be composited together):

A) Drag the second clip from the Media Pool while inside the Fusion page — it becomes a second MediaIn.

B) Render the second clip and re-import as new media.

C) Use the Cut page Sync Bin to merge them first.

D) Apply a Generator effect referencing the other clip.

SECTION VI · MODULE 06

The Color Page — Basics

> *10 questions on Color page mechanics, scopes, primaries, curves, and grade copying.*

047

The Color page operates on the principle that:

- A) You select an effect from a panel and drag it onto a clip.
- B) Whichever clip the playhead is over is automatically the clip being graded.
- C) Each timeline must be re-imported into a separate grading project.
- D) Grades are applied to tracks, not clips.

048

In the Primaries palette, dragging the master wheel under the *Gain* wheel to the right does:

- A) Increases saturation across the image.
- B) Brightens the entire image, with the strongest effect on highlights.
- C) Adds blue to the highlights.
- D) Increases contrast.

049

An S-curve in the Custom Curves panel (lift the upper midtones, depress the lower midtones) produces:

- A) Increased contrast in a filmic way — deeper blacks and brighter highlights.
- B) Reduced contrast across the whole tonal range.
- C) A blue colour cast across the image.
- D) Inversion of the image's brightness.

050

Looking at the Parade scope on a shot where the wall should be neutral grey: the red channel is noticeably higher than green and blue at the wall's horizontal position. The image is:

- A) Tinted red — correct by pulling the Offset wheel toward cyan until R, G, B align.
- B) Underexposed — lift the gamma.
- C) Saturated correctly — leave alone.
- D) Showing chromatic aberration — apply a lens correction.

051

The Vectorscope shows your skin tones cluster far from the diagonal "skin line." Which is the strongest action?

A) Stylistic skin off the skin line is always wrong — pull skin onto the line immediately.

B) Use the Main Object isolation node and shift skin toward the line, unless a stylistic choice intentionally deviates.

C) Apply Face Refinement at full strength.

D) Lower global saturation until skin is grey.

052

Fastest way to copy a grade from one timeline clip to another:

A) Right-click source → Save Grade → right-click target → Apply Saved Grade.

B) Select target, mouse over source's thumbnail, middle-click.

C) Edit → Copy → switch to target → Paste Attributes.

D) Drag the source clip's node graph onto the target's clip thumbnail.

053

You want a creative look that affects every clip in the timeline simultaneously. The right scope for that grade is:

A) Each clip individually with copy-paste.

B) A timeline-level node — switch to the timeline node graph using the small dots above the node graph.

C) A pre-clip group grade.

D) A post-clip group grade.

054

Disabling a single colour node temporarily (to see its contribution) is done by:

A) Right-click → Delete Node.

B) Click the small number on the node.

C) Drag the node off the cable.

D) Set its opacity to zero.

055

A still has been grabbed of a beautifully graded shot — it sits in the Gallery as your reference.

To compare other shots to this reference side-by-side on the viewer:

- A) Drag the still onto the viewer.
- B) Right-click the still → Play Still.
- C) Double-click the still — it replaces the timeline.
- D) Save the still as a power grade and apply it.

056

Your project has 80 shots. By shot 50 you realise the look you started with isn't quite right and you slightly shift saturation and contrast as you go.

The "drift" problem is best prevented by:

- A) Frequent breaks to reset your eyes.
- B) Comparing every shot to a single "hero shot" still — never compare shot N to shot N-1.
- C) Working in a colour-neutral grading suite.
- D) Using Resolve's automatic shot matching tool.

SECTION VII · MODULE 07

The Fairlight Page

> *10 questions on Fairlight workflow, tracks, buses, dynamics, and effects.*

057

You can hear your music tracks but the dialogue is barely audible. You add a Compressor to the dialogue. Threshold is set to -10 dB, ratio 4:1, makeup gain 0 dB. Why is the dialogue still quiet?

A) Makeup gain must be positive to compensate for the compression — try +6 dB.

B) The Compressor only affects audio above -10 dB; if dialogue averages below that, no compression and no makeup happens.

C) The dialogue track is muted — check the mute button.

D) The Compressor cannot work on dialogue tracks; use Limiter instead.

058

A character's voice is heard from another room through a closed door.

The audio treatment that best sells the "in another room" feel:

A) Increase volume on that track.

B) Roll off high frequencies with an EQ (high-cut), and reduce overall track volume slightly.

C) Add chorus and reverb generously.

D) Apply a flanger effect.

059

An audio recording imports as a stereo clip but contains the voice only on the left channel. The right approach:

A) Pan the stereo track left to centre the voice — leave it stereo.

B) Right-click in Media Pool → Clip Attributes → Audio → set format to mono / both channels. Then on the timeline track header, right-click → Change Track Type → Mono.

C) Duplicate the clip and stack copies to fake mono.

D) Use Fairlight's "channel rebalance" plugin.

060

A scene has 5 body-drop sound effects on 5 separate tracks. You want to apply consistent compression and reverb across all 5 with one set of controls. The right structure:

A) Apply compression and reverb individually to each track — Fairlight is per-track.

B) Group the 5 tracks (`Ctrl`+`G`) and apply effects to the group.

C) Route all 5 tracks to a single Bus, apply compression and reverb on the Bus.

D) Render all 5 to a single audio file and apply effects to that.

061

In the channel strip, the green strip near the top opens what?

- A) Equalizer.
- B) Dynamics — Compressor, Gate, Expander, Limiter.
- C) Bus routing.
- D) Effects rack.

062

A 30-second music clip needs to fit a 20-second sequence on beat. The non-AI approach to shorten it:

- A) Decrease the timeline frame rate.
- B) Find similar waveform peaks at the start and end of a section you want to keep, blade at those points, splice, add a short crossfade at the splice.
- C) Apply a time-stretch effect with 67% rate.
- D) Render and re-import at a faster speed.

063

In Range mode on the Fairlight timeline, dragging across part of an audio clip does what?

- A) Selects only that range — backspace deletes it; you can apply effects or pull volume keyframes inside it without splitting the clip.
- B) Splits the clip at both ends of the drag.
- C) Creates a new audio track for that range.
- D) Moves the audio waveform vertically.

064

The dialogue audio level varies wildly between very loud and very quiet across one clip. Quickest path to consistent perceived loudness without re-recording:

- A) Manually keyframe volume on every change.
- B) Apply a Compressor with the Dialog Compression preset; refine threshold/ratio so the gain-reduction meter shows -3 to -6 dB on peaks.
- C) Apply a Limiter set to 0 dB.
- D) Increase the track fader to maximum.

065

Three audio tracks (dialogue, music, SFX) all route to Bus 1 (main mix). You want all dialogue to share one EQ but not the music or SFX. The correct route:

A) Add EQ to Bus 1 — it filters dialogue only by frequency.

B) Create a Dialogue Bus, route dialogue tracks there, route the Dialogue Bus to Bus 1, apply EQ on the Dialogue Bus.

C) Apply EQ to each dialogue clip individually.

D) Group the dialogue tracks and apply EQ to the group.

066

A new bus is created (Fairlight → Bus Format) but nothing routed to it plays through. Most likely cause:

A) The bus has no output assigned — it must be routed to Bus 1 or a final output.

B) The bus is muted by default.

C) Buses cannot carry audio in the free version.

D) The sample rate is wrong.

The Deliver Page

> *10 questions on render settings, codec choice, queue management, and delivery edge cases.*

067

A client wants a master file to archive that they can re-edit in five years if needed. The right codec choice is:

- A) H.264 — universally compatible.
- B) H.265 — smallest file size.
- C) ProRes 422 HQ or 4444 — large but visually pristine and easy to decode in any future NLE.
- D) QuickTime Animation — lossless.

068

A 1080p edit will be uploaded to YouTube. The "trick" to make it look noticeably cleaner after YouTube's re-encoding:

- A) Render in H.265 instead of H.264.
- B) Upscale the deliver resolution to Ultra HD (3840×2160) — YouTube applies a different encoder to 4K uploads, improving final quality.
- C) Render at 10-bit colour depth.
- D) Increase the bitrate to 50 Mbps.

069

A client asks for an MP4 video file. The container is MP4. What codec is conventionally used inside it?

A) ProRes.

B) H.264 (sometimes H.265) — these are the typical codecs paired with MP4.

C) DNxHR.

D) QuickTime Animation.

070

After hitting Render, the rendered file plays back with white blocks appearing randomly across the image. Most likely cause:

A) The codec is corrupted.

B) The Mac is overheating during render and skipping frames — render in a cooler environment with better airflow.

C) The deliver resolution is too high for the source.

D) Resolve free is rate-limited at low frame rates.

071

You add a subtitle track in the Edit page using the Subtitle generator. After delivery the subtitles do not appear in the output file. Most likely cause:

- A) The subtitle format wasn't set to "Burn into video" in the Deliver page subtitle settings.
- B) The subtitle clip is on a separate timeline.
- C) Subtitles only render in H.265.
- D) The subtitle track was muted.

072

You need to render the same timeline as three deliverables: a YouTube version, a client preview, and a ProRes archive. You want them all to render unattended overnight.

The right approach:

- A) Open three Resolves and start each render in parallel.
- B) Configure each as a separate render job, Add to Render Queue, then Render All — they process sequentially.
- C) Render manually one at a time during the day.
- D) Use the Cut page's batch export.

073

For an archive master, the audio settings should be:

A) AAC, stereo, 16-bit — universally compatible.

B) Linear PCM (WAV-style), 32-bit float if available, with "All Timeline Tracks" rather than a stereo mixdown.

C) MP3 320 kbps.

D) Whatever the input audio was, unchanged.

074

The "Individual Clips" render option does:

A) Renders only the currently selected clip on the timeline.

B) Renders each timeline clip as a separate file — useful for batch-transcoding camera media to ProRes, or per-clip client review.

C) Renders the timeline as multiple parallel video tracks in one file.

D) Splits a single clip into multiple resolution variants.

075

A render fails partway. Resolve's error log shows "GPU memory exceeded." Best diagnostic step:

- A) Resolve is at fault — file a bug report.
- B) Reduce GPU load: lower deliver resolution, disable Resolve FX on heavy clips, close other GPU-using apps, then re-render.
- C) Switch to CPU-only rendering.
- D) Restart the machine and try again at the same settings.

076

An H.265 export from the free version of Resolve on Windows fails to start. Most likely cause:

- A) The free Windows version cannot render H.265 — Studio is required for H.265 on Windows.
- B) The codec is corrupt — reinstall Resolve.
- C) The deliver page is misconfigured.
- D) The footage is too low resolution for H.265.

BREAK POINT · Q75 REACHED · SUGGESTED 15-MINUTE REST

You are halfway through. The second half tests deeper colour-grading judgement.

SECTION IX · MODULE 09

Color Management Setup

> *8 questions on log footage, working spaces, and CST configuration.*

077

Why do professional cameras record in log instead of standard Rec.709?

A) Log files are smaller than Rec.709.

B) Log packs maximum dynamic range and colour information into the file at the cost of an unattractive flat appearance — to be corrected in post.

C) Log is required for HDR delivery.

D) Log is faster to record.

078

In Project Settings, the recommended "future-proof" Color Processing Mode for modern grading is:

A) Rec.709 / Rec.709 — match input to output.

B) HDR DaVinci Wide Gamut Intermediate — wide enough for any camera, log-shaped for accurate maths.

C) SDR Rec.2020.

D) The camera's native log space.

079

Mac users grading a feature for theatrical and streaming delivery.

Which Output Color Space best matches what the user will see on consumer playback (QuickTime, Safari)?

A) Rec.709 Gamma 2.4.

B) Rec.709-A — Apple's slight gamma compensation matches Mac playback.

C) DCI-P3.

D) Rec.2020.

080

A clip was shot on a Sony A7S III in S-Log3. What Input Color Space tag should it receive in the Media Pool?

A) Sony S-Log3.

B) S-Gamut3.Cine / S-Log3.

C) Sony Rec.709.

D) DaVinci Wide Gamut.

081

An iPhone shot in its default video mode (not Pro / not Apple Log) should be tagged as:

A) Apple Log.

B) Rec.709 Gamma 2.4 — the iPhone's default output is Rec.709.

C) iPhone Log.

D) DaVinci Wide Gamut.

082

A clip is mislabelled in the Input Color Space — set to Rec.709 when it's actually S-Log3. The image looks "almost right" but slightly off. The danger is:

A) None — small mislabels don't affect the grade.

B) A subtle, hard-to-spot wrongness propagates through every downstream grade choice — much harder to diagnose than an obvious error.

C) The clip will refuse to render.

D) The CST node will turn red.

083

Rather than project-wide colour management, an alternative is to handle conversion per-clip using:

A) A Color Space Transform (CST) node as the first node in the grade.

B) A LUT applied at the project level.

C) A custom RAW decoder.

D) The Studio-only HDR module.

084

You're given mixed footage: Sony A7S III in S-Log3, an iPhone in Apple Log, and broadcast B-roll already in Rec.709.

The clean workflow:

A) Convert all clips to Rec.709 before importing.

B) Tag each clip's Input Color Space in the Media Pool — project-wide colour management handles each correctly into the working space.

C) Make three separate projects, one per camera.

D) Disable colour management and grade each clip differently by eye.

SECTION X · MODULE 10

The Node Tree Architecture

> *8 questions on the Notary Structure and node types.*

085

The three conceptual columns of the Notary Structure, in order:

A) Look — Balance — Isolate.

B) Balance — Isolate — Global Look.

C) Isolate — Balance — Sharpen.

D) Curves — Wheels — Effects.

086

A Serial node connection means:

A) Multiple corrections operate on the same source image simultaneously.

B) Each node operates on the previous node's output — order matters.

C) Connections render in the background.

D) The two nodes share a single set of controls.

087

A Parallel Mixer node combines its inputs how?

- A) Bottom branches override top branches (priority order).
- B) All branches start from the same source and sum equally — no precision compounding loss.
- C) Branches multiply together.
- D) The mixer picks the most-saturated branch at each pixel.

088

A Layer Mixer node combines its branches how?

- A) Equally summed.
- B) Bottom branches take priority — they sit on top, like Photoshop layers.
- C) Branches are blended by image hue.
- D) The brightest branch wins per pixel.

089

In the Notary Structure, the Main Object node is wired as the *bottom* branch of the Layer Mixer because:

A) Layer mixers process bottom-first.

B) The Main Object should take priority — corrections applied to the background must not affect it. Bottom branches override top branches in a Layer Mixer.

C) It connects naturally to the CST out.

D) Convention only — order doesn't actually matter.

090

A grade involves: exposure correction, contrast adjustment, blue tint, skin isolation, vignette, and final film grain. The right distribution across node types:

A) Everything in serial nodes — simplest.

B) Balance (exposure, contrast) in serial; skin isolation via Layer Mixer; tint and vignette via Parallel Mixer; grain in a final serial node.

C) Everything in one parallel mixer.

D) One Layer Mixer per correction.

091

A custom keyboard shortcut for "Label Selected Node" is most useful because:

A) It makes the node graph print more legibly.

B) Naming nodes as you work (with `F2`) preserves understanding when you return to the project days later — you can see what each node is for.

C) It enables Studio-only features.

D) Labels render automatically into the export.

092

A power grade (`.drx` file) imported into the Gallery's Power Grades folder lets you:

A) Apply a complete pre-built node tree to any clip with one click — the entire Notary Structure can be inherited.

B) Lock the grade so it can't be modified.

C) Convert the grade to a single LUT.

D) Apply only the colour wheel positions, not the node structure.

SECTION XI · MODULE 11

Balancing Nodes

> *8 questions on exposure, contrast, saturation, and the role of balancing.*

093

The Parade scope shows the waveform of your image bunched in the lower third (everything dark) with no signal reaching the top. The right initial move:

A) Push gain up to extend highlights toward 1023, then refine gamma to lift midtones.

B) Increase saturation.

C) Apply a sharpening filter.

D) Change the Output Color Space.

094

The top of the waveform shows a flat horizontal line at 1023. This indicates:

A) Perfect exposure.

B) Highlights are clipped — pixel values exceeding 1023 are all recorded as 1023, and the original detail is lost.

C) The image is over-saturated.

D) The codec is failing.

095

A "muddy" image — skin tones feel dark and blotchy. The cleanest fix in the Contrast node:

A) Apply heavy global contrast.

B) Apply moderate contrast with the pivot pulled left, so blacks deepen without crushing midtones.

C) Apply a Glow effect.

D) Push saturation up.

096

At the balancing stage, the right amount of saturation to add is:

A) Maximum — push to full so the grade has plenty to work with.

B) Modest — just enough that the qualifier can distinguish regions (e.g. skin from sky).

C) Zero — desaturate completely until the global look.

D) None of the above — saturation isn't part of balancing.

097

A scene was shot in a candle-lit room and reads as warm orange throughout.

Should you white-balance it to neutral?

A) Yes — every scene must be neutralised first.

B) No — balancing fixes *errors*, not character. Candle light is warm by nature; leave the warmth as the scene's identity.

C) Only if delivering for broadcast.

D) Only if there's skin in the frame.

098

In Studio, the HDR Wheels palette differs from standard Primaries by:

A) Six tonal regions instead of three (lift/gamma/gain), each with independent thresholds.

B) HDR-only colour space support.

C) Required for 4K work.

D) Different colour wheel mathematics.

099

Why use HDR Wheels for balancing rather than standard Primaries?

A) HDR Wheels are faster.

B) You can pull Lights down to recover a blown sky while Shadows stays untouched — surgical control standard wheels can't match cleanly.

C) They produce better skin tones automatically.

D) They reduce noise.

100

After balancing, the image should look:

A) Like the final grade — the look is now built.

B) Neutral, well-exposed, with full tonal range — a clean starting point for creative work.

C) Heavily saturated — saturation defines the look.

D) Identical to the camera's preview.

SECTION XII · MODULE 12

Color Isolation & the Layer Mixer

> *10 questions on qualifiers, masks, tracking, and isolation strategy.*

101

A Qualifier picks pixels by:

A) Hue, Saturation, and Luminance.

B) Position in the frame.

C) Time on the timeline.

D) Codec encoding values.

102

A skin qualifier selection looks broken and blocky on 8-bit phone footage. The most effective remedies:

A) Use a Square mask.

B) Increase Denoise and Blur Radius in Matte Finesse; consider Pre-filter; add a Power Window around the face to limit spurious picks.

C) Convert the footage to 16-bit.

D) Apply Sharpen first.

103

A Power Window is best used:

- A) Instead of a Qualifier.
- B) With a Qualifier — the qualifier picks pixels by colour; the window adds a geometric constraint so the correction applies only inside the window AND inside the qualifier selection.
- C) For light leak effects.
- D) For audio mixing.

104

A Power Window is drawn around a subject's face. The subject walks across the frame. Without intervention, the window stays fixed and the face leaves it. The fix:

- A) Make the window much larger to cover the path.
- B) On the window's Tracker tab, click "Track Forward and Reverse" — Resolve auto-tracks the window to follow the face.
- C) Keyframe the window position by hand on every frame.
- D) Apply Magic Mask instead.

105

Magic Mask is most useful when:

A) You need a moving mask that follows a subject (a person, a face, an object) across a shot, and you have Studio.

B) You need to apply a global colour cast.

C) You're working in the free version.

D) You need to denoise audio.

106

In the Layer Mixer pattern of the Notary Structure, when you push blue into the Background node, the skin (isolated in the Main Object node) stays unchanged. Why?

A) The Background's qualifier is set to skin colour.

B) The Main Object is on the bottom branch of the Layer Mixer, which takes priority over higher branches.

C) The skin is automatically protected by Resolve's AI.

D) Background corrections never apply to skin areas.

107

The Vectorscope's "skin tone indicator" line runs diagonally from centre toward approximately:

A) 3 o'clock.

B) 11 o'clock — the typical position of healthy human skin tones regardless of ethnicity.

C) 9 o'clock.

D) 5 o'clock.

108

A skin qualifier selection has spurious noise picks on a wall that happens to be skin-coloured. The cleanest way to exclude the wall without re-doing the qualifier:

A) Reduce Hue width on the qualifier until skin selects but the wall doesn't.

B) Add a Power Window around the face — the correction now applies only where the qualifier selects AND inside the window.

C) Apply Magic Mask on top.

D) Add a tracking marker on the face.

109

A common error: a colourist pushes the Main Object skin grade aggressively (very strong shift) and notices "halos" or fringing around the face. Cause:

A) The codec is too compressed.

B) Imperfections in the qualifier matte become visible as the correction grows more extreme. Strong isolation looks worst on cheap footage; restraint always wins.

C) The vectorscope is misconfigured.

D) Resolve's free version limits isolation strength.

110

A 4-camera dialogue scene. Each camera has slightly different colour. You want the skin tones to look identical across cameras while leaving the backgrounds untouched (the backgrounds in each angle are different parts of the room).

The right approach:

A) Apply one global LUT to all clips.

B) Per clip: isolate skin in the Main Object node, then use the still-comparison technique with a hero shot to match skin while leaving each background as graded for that angle.

C) Render each camera separately, grade afterwards.

D) Crop the backgrounds out.

The Global Look

> *10 questions on creative grading, curves, and the global look creation process.*

111

Before pushing a single slider in the Global Look, you should:

A) Apply a stylistic LUT for inspiration.

B) Choose a hero frame — one frame that represents the look you're aiming for, well-lit, with the main subject — and grade against that frame first.

C) Increase saturation globally.

D) Grade the first frame of the timeline.

112

An "S-curve" in Custom Curves typically means:

A) A curve that resembles the letter S — upper midtones lifted, lower midtones depressed — adding film-like contrast.

B) A curve set to "Spline" interpolation.

C) A saturation curve.

D) A curve mirrored on the Y axis.

113

A reference still imported into the Gallery is most useful for:

A) Copying its grade onto your shot.

B) Visual comparison against your shot via split-screen — guiding your eye toward similar tonal distribution without literally copying.

C) Permanently locking the look.

D) Replacing your shot.

114

The "teal-orange" look means:

A) Teal in the shadows, orange in the highlights — the modern blockbuster look. Restraint is essential.

B) Orange in the shadows, teal in the highlights.

C) The whole image tinted teal.

D) Skin in teal, sky in orange.

115

After applying the Global Look, the skin tone looks wrong. The correct fix in the Notary Structure:

A) Re-do the Global Look from scratch.

B) Adjust the Main Object node — because skin is isolated there, you can shift skin back toward the skin line independently of the global tint.

C) Disable the Global Look entirely.

D) Reduce overall saturation.

116

The Color Slicer's "HSV saturation" differs from the standard saturation slider by:

A) Affecting only red and orange channels.

B) Boosting saturation without changing the image's brightness or contrast.

C) Being available only in the free version.

D) Working only in HDR projects.

117

Why does the Notary Structure use a Parallel Mixer (not Serial) around the Global Look adjustments?

A) Parallel renders faster.

B) All Global adjustments start from the same source and sum equally — preventing precision compounding loss across multiple operations.

C) Parallel allows non-sequential keyframes.

D) It looks cleaner in the node graph.

118

A grade is described as "strong" or "extreme." The trade-off:

A) The stronger the look, the more visible any imperfection in the underlying isolations or footage.

B) Strong grades render faster.

C) Strong grades work better on phone footage.

D) Strong grades pass YouTube compression more cleanly.

119

Toggling the entire grade on and off, a viewer should feel:

A) "Wow, that's a huge difference" — the louder the grade the better.

B) A subtle but felt improvement — the grade enhances rather than replaces the underlying image.

C) Nothing — a perfect grade is invisible.

D) Confused — a good grade should surprise the viewer.

120

A junior colourist applies an aggressive teal-orange look and the wide shots match the close-ups poorly. Most likely cause:

A) Strong looks amplify exposure and white-balance differences between angles — match shots more carefully before pushing the look further.

B) Resolve's Color page glitches at high saturation.

C) The looks were applied at different times of day.

D) Teal-orange specifically doesn't work in multi-camera setups.

Power Windows & Adjustments

> *8 questions on power windows, face refinement, color slicer, and color warper.*

121

A vignette is typically built as:

A) A circle Power Window with the Key Output set to Invert, then offset pulled down to darken the inverted (outer) area.

B) A polygon mask around the corners.

C) A Glow effect with negative gain.

D) A LUT named "Vignette."

122

The "subject brightening" Power Window technique works because:

A) The eye is drawn to lit areas — gently lifting the subject's face draws attention there. Cinematographers have used this principle for a century.

B) Brighter areas render faster.

C) Subject brightening fixes underexposure.

D) It removes shadows from the background.

123

Face Refinement's "skin smoothing" is most natural-looking when:

A) Set to maximum strength.

B) Set subtly — around 0.3–0.5 — with the Scaling control pulled down so skin texture isn't completely wiped.

C) Combined with full sharpening.

D) Applied to every clip uniformly.

124

The Color Warper differs from Hue vs Hue curves in that it:

A) Affects luminance instead of hue.

B) Lets you click a colour on the viewer to add a hexagonal-grid control point, then drag the point to shift that hue, with selective falloff controlled by a radius — surgical changes other tools can't match.

C) Is faster to render.

D) Works only in 8-sided mode.

125

A Power Window is built around a face. The subject's head turns slightly. The grade now "drifts" off the face. The most reliable solution:

A) Disable the Power Window.

B) Track the window via its Tracker tab — Resolve auto-keyframes the window to follow the face.

C) Make the window much larger.

D) Use Magic Mask instead.

126

Face Refinement's Eye Bag Removal is most appropriate when:

A) The performer has dark under-eye shadows and a subtle lightening serves the scene — used very gently.

B) The performer is tired but the scene calls for it.

C) Always — eyebags should be removed in all professional work.

D) Never — Face Refinement should not touch eyes.

127

A common visual failure with Face Refinement is:

- A) It crashes Resolve.
- B) Pushed past about 30% strength on any control, skin looks plastic — like a video-game character. Viewers should think "they look good," not "they look retouched."
- C) It only works in studio lighting.
- D) It can't track moving faces.

128

A Power Window has been positioned and tracked. The track drifts halfway through the shot. The right next step:

- A) Re-track from the start with different settings.
- B) Manually keyframe the window's position on the drifting frames — Resolve uses your keyframes to override the auto-tracker.
- C) Abandon power windows; use Magic Mask.
- D) Apply a Gaussian blur to mask the drift.

SECTION XV · MODULE 15

Final Look & Refinement

> *8 questions on final-look serial nodes, grain, sharpening, and aspect ratios.*

129

A Final Look node sits in serial after the Global Look node. Its purpose:

A) To redo the Global Look.

B) To push the image one more step further on top of the parallel-mixer's output — final darkening, casts, or curve adjustments.

C) To apply a LUT.

D) To render the file.

130

In Studio's native Film Grain effect, "Advanced Controls" allow you to:

A) Add grain only at specific tonal ranges (e.g., reduce grain in shadows to keep black areas clean).

B) Animate grain size over time.

C) Sync grain to audio peaks.

D) Replace grain with a LUT.

131

In the free version, film grain is typically added by:

A) The native Film Grain effect.

B) An overlay video file placed on a track above the edit, with composite mode set to Overlay.

C) A LUT.

D) An audio plugin.

132

In the Blur palette (Color page), the Radius slider behavior is:

A) Always blurs — higher values blur more.

B) Below 0.5 = sharpen, above 0.5 = blur. Default 0.5 is no effect.

C) Always sharpens — higher values sharpen more.

D) Radius affects only luminance, not chroma.

133

The under-discussed Sharpening control "Scaling" determines:

A) The output resolution of the sharpen.

B) Which pixel-size features get sharpened — higher scaling targets larger features (eyes, lips); lower scaling targets fine texture. Pushing scaling toward 1.0 produces strikingly detailed images for social media.

C) The Resolve render priority.

D) The colour space of the sharpen filter.

134

To deliver a cinematic 2.39:1 image without re-cropping the footage:

A) Re-shoot in anamorphic.

B) Use Output Blanking → 2.39:1 in the Color page. Black bars top and bottom; image stays full-frame. Re-frame inside the bars using Sizing → Input.

C) Add black bars manually in Fusion.

D) Crop the timeline to 2.39:1 in Project Settings.

135

Adding a tiny Gaussian Blur (radius 0.05–0.15) in the Fine Tune node serves to:

A) Mask noise that grading exposed.

B) Take the digital "edge" off footage — emulating the soft optics of film lenses; combined with grain, produces an analogue feel.

C) Reduce file size.

D) Prevent banding.

136

A common pitfall when applying film grain in the Studio version:

A) The grain has no parameters.

B) Grain is computationally expensive — playback may slow noticeably; render at full quality only when finalising, or use the proxy mode while grading.

C) Grain renders incorrectly at 4K.

D) Grain only works in HDR projects.

SECTION XVI · MODULE 16

Grading Different Footage Types

> *8 questions on adapting the workflow to footage of different origins.*

137

An iPhone shot in default (Rec.709) mode imports into the Notary Structure. The CST in node should be configured as:

A) Apple Log input.

B) Input Rec.709 → Output Rec.709 (effectively a bypass — the footage is already in display space).

C) S-Log3 input.

D) Wide Gamut Intermediate input.

138

A heavy creative push on 8-bit phone footage typically reveals:

A) Higher dynamic range than expected.

B) Banding in skies, blocky qualifier mattes, and broken-up isolations — the bit depth limits the latitude.

C) Improved sharpness.

D) Cleaner skin tones than log footage.

139

A common high-leverage move on phone footage is:

A) Maximum saturation push.

B) White-balance correction — phones often produce cool indoor footage that warms naturally with one Offset shift.

C) Extreme colour isolation.

D) Skipping the balancing column.

140

An iPhone 15 Pro shooting in Apple Log should be treated as:

A) Phone footage — limited latitude.

B) A proper log camera — 10-bit Apple Log grades comparably to mid-tier mirrorless. CST in: Input Apple Log.

C) Inferior to S-Log3.

D) Rec.709 with a hidden curve.

141

Stock footage downloaded from a library is typically in Rec.709 and arrives "over-graded." The right preparation before adding your own grade:

A) Apply your grade on top — the original grade adds character.

B) Use the balancing column to neutralise — pull saturation down to a working level, fix exposure if needed — then grade. Otherwise you're stacking grade on grade.

C) Re-export the footage at 16-bit first.

D) Apply a "Reset to Camera" LUT.

142

A DJI drone clip recorded in D-Log shows strong magenta colour fringing along high-contrast edges. The right place to address this:

A) Increase saturation to mask the fringing.

B) Use the balancing column (or a dedicated chromatic aberration / lens correction effect) before the creative grade — addressing optical issues before stylistic choices.

C) Apply the magenta in the Global Look.

D) Re-export the clip and reimport.

143

A mixed-source project: 10-bit Sony S-Log3 from one camera, 10-bit Apple Log iPhone from another. After tagging each clip's Input Color Space, the Notary Structure applied identically to each clip will:

- A) Produce visibly different results between the two cameras.
- B) Produce a consistent starting point on each, because colour management has converted both into the same working space — the same structure operates on equivalent base images.
- C) Crash Resolve.
- D) Force you to re-balance every clip individually.

144

A junior colourist insists every clip in their project must have its Skin tone perfectly on the vectorscope's skin line. Which is the strongest correction to that view?

- A) They're right — skin must always be on the line.
- B) They're partly right — natural skin lives on the line. Stylistic choices (sci-fi, period, dream sequences) can deliberately deviate. The line is a target to land on or deliberately leave, not a law.
- C) They're wrong — the line is irrelevant.
- D) The line only applies to bright skin tones.

Decisions Under Pressure

> *6 questions integrating multiple modules — these test holistic judgement.*

145

A client delivers 2 hours of S-Log3 footage from a Sony FX6, shot mostly handheld. They need: (a) a 90-second hero edit for Instagram (vertical), (b) a 3-minute web cut (16:9), (c) a ProRes master archive. Deadline is 5 days. You work alone.

The most efficient sequencing of the work:

- **A)** Build all three timelines first, then grade each separately, then mix audio, then deliver in batch.
- **B)** Cut the 3-minute master in 16:9; lock picture; grade once on this timeline with the Notary Structure; duplicate the timeline to create the Instagram vertical cut and re-frame in Sizing → Input; mix audio on the master; render all three (web H.265, Instagram H.265 vertical, ProRes archive) via the Render Queue.
- **C)** Grade every clip separately; then assemble three timelines from graded clips.
- **D)** Render the master first in H.264 then re-edit from that for the other deliverables.

A long-take interview was shot in 4K H.265 on a 25 fps timeline. Playback stutters in the Edit page. You have 4 hours until the client review.

The fastest fix that doesn't compromise final quality:

A) Buy a new GPU before the meeting.

B) Generate optimised media or proxies (Playback menu → Render Cache / Optimised Media); the edit experience becomes smooth, final output remains from the original files.

C) Re-export the source to H.264 and re-import.

D) Drop the timeline to 1080p resolution.

A documentary protagonist filmed his own interviews on his iPhone over a year. His skin tone is consistently warmer than your studio-shot footage. The director wants every shot to feel like one consistent world.

The principled approach:

- A) Pull the warm shots back to neutral so all skin matches.
- B) Decide whether warmth is character (e.g. lived-in, intimate) or error. If character, embrace it across both — push your studio shots warmer to match. If error, neutralise the phone footage's warmth with a per-clip white-balance correction in the balancing column.
- C) Use Magic Mask on every face.
- D) Apply face refinement to all faces equally.

You complete a grade on a hero shot using a strong stylised look. When you copy the grade (middle-click) to a second shot, the second shot looks unbalanced — the look "fits" the hero but reveals problems on the new shot.

The correct response:

A) The look is wrong — start over.

B) The look amplifies underlying differences between shots. Adjust the second shot's Clip-level Balancing nodes (exposure, contrast, white balance) until it matches the hero's starting point — then the same look will sit better.

C) Use a different look on the second shot.

D) Disable timeline-level grades.

An editor cuts a podcast in the Cut page and hands you the project. You open it on the Edit page to finesse. Some clips have split points but no cuts (through-edits). You also notice volume keyframes that look harsh between sections.

The cleanest cleanup:

A) Re-cut from scratch.

B) Right-click each through-edit → Delete Through Edit (joins the clip back). For the harsh volume changes, add short audio crossfades at the volume transitions, or smooth the keyframes by replacing them with a crossfade.

C) Delete all keyframes globally.

D) Disable audio tracks and re-mix from raw.

150

A client signs off on your final cut on Monday. On Wednesday, they request that the lead actor's blue jumper become red throughout the film "for brand reasons." There are 60 shots featuring the jumper.

The expert-level workflow that respects time and quality:

A) Re-shoot.

B) Group all 60 clips into a Color page Group. In the Group's post-clip node graph, qualify the blue jumper (Hue vs Hue or Qualifier + Power Window per clip if necessary), shift hue to red. Apply once, propagates to all 60. Track windows per-clip where needed.

C) Edit each clip individually with no shared workflow.

D) Tell the client the change is impossible.

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